

Cause: This generally happens when the second drive has a primary partition on it. Since primary partitions take precedence over extended ones, it will take up a drive letter immediately after the primary partition of the first drive, i.e., C:.

Solution: After installing the second drive, make sure the drive is formatted and that all partitions created are extended. If the second drive contains data, move the data to the first drive and then remove all the partitions before creating new (extended) ones.

► **Problem:** You get an “Invalid media type” error.

Cause: This generally occurs when one tries to view a non-formatted, non-partitioned drive in Windows, or when you try to view a different file type in an OS that does not support that particular file type. For example, trying to view an NTFS partition in Windows 98 will result in this error.

Solution: First use a bootable floppy or CD-ROM, and then use FDISK to see what type of partitions are present on the drive. The fourth option in FDISK lets you do that. If a non-Windows partition exists, delete it and create a new FAT32 or NTFS partition that Windows can recognise. If the drive is brand new, then creating new partitions and subsequently formatting them should help.

► **Problem:** Your hard drive is not detected in the BIOS.

Cause: This is the most common problem with hard drives, and it has a simple solution too. Improper connection of the power cable results in this problem. Also, current-generation drives require more power to run, so if your power supply isn't powerful enough, the hard drives will fail to start up.

Solution: Check whether the power connector is connected properly; if you think it is, then touch the drive. A powered drive will always vibrate a little because of the high-speed spinning of the platters. If the drive doesn't seem to vibrate, the platters aren't spinning, and the drive requires more power to work—in which case, you'll need to change your power supply. If it is vibrating and still the drive isn't recognised then probably there is some problem with the data cable connection, or the BIOS is not set up properly.